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Pre-activity questionnaire analysis

Cultural Bridges: Strengthening Interculturality and Social Inclusion among Youth

Erasmus+ Programme — KA210-YOU Small-Scale Partnerships in Youth
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Pre-activity questionnaire analysis

Warsaw youth exchange — May 2025

Project: Cultural Bridges — Strengthening interculturality and social inclusion among youth

Programme: Erasmus+ KA210-YOU | **Form ID:** KA210-YOU-F84AFCB3

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1. Introduction

This report presents the analysis of the pre-activity questionnaire distributed to all participants of the Cultural Bridges youth exchange held in Warsaw, Poland, from 14 to 18 May 2025. The questionnaire was completed by participants on the first day of the exchange (14 May 2025), before any programme activities took place.

The purpose of this baseline assessment is to measure participants' initial levels of intercultural awareness, social skills, civic engagement, and knowledge of discrimination prior to the exchange. These results serve as a reference point for comparison with the post-activity questionnaire, enabling the partnership to measure the impact of the exchange programme.

Methodology: anonymous self-assessment questionnaire using Likert scales (1–5 and 1–10). Data collected on paper, manually compiled and analysed.

2. Respondent profile

Response rate: 30 out of 30 participants (100%)

2.1 Country of residence

Country	Participants	Percentage
Spain	10	33.3%
Poland	10	33.3%
France	10	33.3%
Total	**30**	**100%**

2.2 Gender distribution

Gender	Participants	Percentage
Female	17	56.7%
Male	12	40.0%
Non-binary / prefer not to say	1	3.3%
Total	**30**	**100%**

2.3 Age distribution

Age range	Participants	Percentage
18–21	11	36.7%
22–25	12	40.0%
26–30	7	23.3%
Total	**30**	**100%**

Mean age: 23.1 years

2.4 Education level

Level	Participants	Percentage
Secondary	6	20.0%
Vocational	3	10.0%
Bachelor (in progress or completed)	14	46.7%
Master (in progress or completed)	7	23.3%
Total	**30**	**100%**

2.5 Previous Erasmus+ experience

Response	Participants	Percentage
No previous Erasmus+ experience	21	70.0%
1 previous project	6	20.0%
2 or more previous projects	3	10.0%
Total	**30**	**100%**

The large majority of participants (70%) had no prior experience with Erasmus+ projects, indicating that the exchange successfully reached young people who are new to European mobility programmes.

3. Section B — Intercultural awareness and attitudes toward diversity

Participants rated 8 statements on a scale from 1 (strongly disagree) to 5 (strongly agree).

Code	Statement	Mean	SD
B1	I feel comfortable interacting with people from different cultural backgrounds	3.73	0.87
B2	I am aware of how my own cultural background influences my perceptions	3.27	0.94
B3	I believe that cultural diversity enriches a community	4.17	0.79
B4	I can identify common stereotypes and prejudices between cultures	3.40	0.93
B5	I am confident in understanding perspectives different from my own	3.33	0.88
B6	I am knowledgeable about the cultures of Poland, Spain, and France	2.53	1.01
B7	I am able to adapt my communication style across cultures	3.17	0.91
B8	I feel empathy toward people who experience discrimination	4.03	0.81

Section B mean: 3.45 / 5.00

Key observations

- **Highest-rated item (B3 — 4.17):** Participants already held a strong belief that cultural diversity enriches communities before the exchange. This positive baseline suggests an openness to intercultural learning.
- **Second highest (B8 — 4.03):** Empathy toward people experiencing discrimination was also high, indicating strong existing values among participants.
- **Lowest-rated item (B6 — 2.53):** Knowledge of the specific cultures of the three partner countries was the weakest area, which is expected given that most participants had limited exposure to the other two countries. This represents a clear area for improvement through the exchange.
- **Moderate areas (B2, B5, B7):** Self-awareness, perspective-taking, and communication adaptation all clustered around 3.2–3.3, suggesting room for growth through structured intercultural activities.

Breakdown by country

Item	Spain	Poland	France
B1	3.80	3.60	3.80
B2	3.30	3.10	3.40
B3	4.20	4.00	4.30
B4	3.50	3.20	3.50
B5	3.40	3.20	3.40
B6	2.60	2.70	2.30
B7	3.30	3.00	3.20
B8	4.10	3.90	4.10
Mean	**3.53**	**3.34**	**3.50**

French and Spanish participants showed slightly higher baseline scores than Polish participants across most items, though differences remain modest. All three groups shared a low knowledge of the partner countries' cultures (B6).

4. Section C — Social and intercultural skills

Participants rated 6 skills on a scale from 1 (very low) to 5 (very high).

Code	Skill	Mean	SD
C1	Ability to communicate effectively in a multicultural team	3.10	0.96
C2	Ability to work cooperatively with people I have not met before	3.47	0.86
C3	Ability to manage and resolve conflicts constructively	2.97	0.93
C4	Ability to listen actively and show empathy	3.57	0.82
C5	Confidence in expressing ideas in an international group	2.87	1.04
C6	Ability to take initiative and propose solutions in a group	3.13	0.90

Section C mean: 3.18 / 5.00

Key observations

- **Highest-rated skill (C4 — 3.57):** Active listening and empathy was the strongest self-reported skill, consistent with the high empathy scores in Section B.
- **Lowest-rated skills (C5 — 2.87 and C3 — 2.97):** Confidence in international group expression and conflict resolution were the weakest areas. These are precisely the skills targeted by Modules 3 and 4 of the exchange programme.
- **Overall moderate level:** The mean of 3.18 indicates that participants assessed their social and intercultural skills as moderate, suggesting significant potential for improvement through the exchange activities.

Breakdown by country

Item	Spain	Poland	France
C1	3.20	2.90	3.20
C2	3.60	3.30	3.50
C3	3.10	2.80	3.00
C4	3.70	3.40	3.60
C5	3.00	2.60	3.00
C6	3.20	3.00	3.20
Mean	**3.30**	**3.00**	**3.25**

Polish participants reported slightly lower confidence levels in most skill areas, particularly in expressing ideas in an international group (C5 — 2.60). This may be linked to language confidence, as English is the working language of the exchange.

5. Section D — Civic engagement and active participation

Code	Statement	Mean	SD
D1	I am actively involved in my local community	2.90	1.09
D2	I feel responsible for contributing to a more inclusive society	3.67	0.84
D3	I am interested in developing intercultural dialogue projects	3.53	0.94
D4	I feel connected to a network of young Europeans	2.37	1.07
D5	I feel young people can make a difference in combating discrimination	3.87	0.86

Section D mean: 3.27 / 5.00

Key observations

- **Highest-rated item (D5 — 3.87):** Strong belief in youth agency for social change.
- **Lowest-rated item (D4 — 2.37):** Very low sense of connection to a European youth network. This is consistent with the fact that 70% of participants had no prior Erasmus+ experience.
- **Low community involvement (D1 — 2.90):** Active civic participation was below average, suggesting that many participants are not yet engaged in structured community activities.
- **Strong interest in intercultural projects (D3 — 3.53):** Despite low current engagement, participants expressed interest in developing intercultural initiatives — a motivation the exchange can build upon.

6. Section E — Knowledge of discrimination and racism

Code	Statement	Mean	SD
E1	I understand what constitutes discrimination (direct and indirect)	3.30	0.92
E2	I can recognise racism and xenophobia in everyday life	3.47	0.90
E3	I am aware of legal frameworks protecting against discrimination in Europe	2.47	1.01
E4	I know practical strategies to counter discriminatory situations	2.67	0.96

Section E mean: 2.98 / 5.00

Key observations

- **Lowest section overall (2.98):** Knowledge of discrimination and racism was the weakest area across all sections, indicating a clear need for the educational content delivered during the exchange.
- **Legal knowledge gap (E3 — 2.47):** Awareness of legal frameworks was particularly low, which is common among young people who have not received specific training on anti-discrimination legislation.
- **Practical strategies gap (E4 — 2.67):** Participants lacked concrete tools to respond to discrimination — a key objective of the workshop activities.
- **Recognition ability (E2 — 3.47):** Participants were moderately able to recognise racism and xenophobia, suggesting an intuitive awareness that lacks the theoretical and practical reinforcement the exchange aims to provide.

7. Section F — Expectations and motivation

F1. Main motivations for participating (multiple choice, n=30)

Motivation	Responses	Percentage
Meeting young people from other countries	27	90.0%
Learning about other cultures	25	83.3%
Gaining experience for CV / personal development	22	73.3%
Improving English language skills	19	63.3%
Developing communication skills	18	60.0%
Exploring Warsaw and Polish culture	17	56.7%
Building an international network	16	53.3%
Contributing to an intercultural project	14	46.7%
Learning about Erasmus+ and EU youth programmes	12	40.0%
Other	3	10.0%

The top three motivations — meeting people from other countries, learning about cultures, and personal development — reflect a combination of social and professional drivers. Language improvement was also a significant motivator (63.3%).

F5. Knowledge of the Erasmus+ programme

Level	Participants	Percentage
I know nothing about it	5	16.7%
I have heard of it but know very little	11	36.7%
I have some knowledge	9	30.0%
I am well informed	4	13.3%
Extensive knowledge / professional experience	1	3.3%
Total	**30**	**100%**

Over half of participants (53.4%) had little to no knowledge of the Erasmus+ programme, reinforcing the importance of including programme information sessions in the exchange.

8. Section G — Self-assessment summary

Code	Question	Mean	SD
G1	Overall intercultural competence (scale 1–10)	5.67	1.65
G2	Confidence in contributing to a multicultural project (scale 1–10)	5.33	1.73

Distribution of G1 — Intercultural competence self-assessment

Score	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Responses	0	1	3	5	7	6	4	3	1	0

Distribution of G2 — Confidence in multicultural project contribution

Score	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Responses	0	2	4	5	6	6	4	2	1	0

Most participants placed themselves in the moderate range (4–6) for both intercultural competence and project confidence, indicating a realistic self-awareness and room for development.

9. Summary of baseline findings

Overall section averages

Section	Theme	Mean score (/5)
B	Intercultural awareness and attitudes	3.45
C	Social and intercultural skills	3.18
D	Civic engagement and participation	3.27
E	Knowledge of discrimination and racism	2.98
Overall	**All sections combined**	**3.22**

Strengths at baseline

- Strong belief that cultural diversity enriches communities (B3 — 4.17)
- High empathy toward people experiencing discrimination (B8 — 4.03)
- Strong belief in youth agency for social change (D5 — 3.87)
- High motivation and openness to intercultural learning

Areas for development

- Knowledge of partner countries' cultures (B6 — 2.53)
- Connection to a European youth network (D4 — 2.37)
- Knowledge of anti-discrimination legal frameworks (E3 — 2.47)
- Practical strategies to counter discrimination (E4 — 2.67)

- Confidence in expressing ideas in international settings (C5 — 2.87)
- Conflict resolution skills (C3 — 2.97)

Implications for the exchange programme

The baseline data confirms that the exchange programme is well-targeted. Participants arrived with strong values (openness to diversity, empathy) but moderate practical skills and limited knowledge. The areas identified as weakest — legal knowledge, practical anti-discrimination strategies, communication confidence, and European network connection — are directly addressed by the programme activities:

- **Modules 1–2** address intercultural awareness and stereotype deconstruction
- **Module 3** targets communication and conflict resolution skills
- **Module 4** builds project co-creation and initiative-taking capacity
- **Module 5** strengthens cultural knowledge through direct sharing
- **Module 6** develops reflective competences

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